

TAIL-PIECE : BRANDING BABIES BY HOT IRON RODS- A BAD PRACTICE

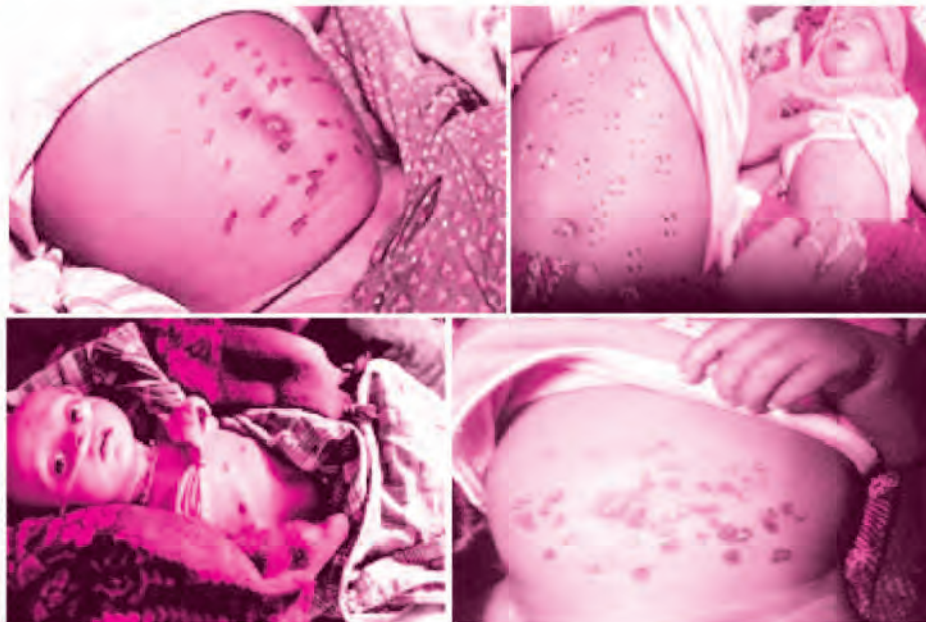
Pre-reading

You have already read the lesson "Birsa Munda". Birsa Munda fought against superstition in the society. Read the following text to know about some other bad practices in our society. We will also know what we have to do.

Look at the following newspaper headings and pictures.

"Branding by Hot Iron Rods Kills Five Babies in Nawarangpur."

"Seven Babies Die in Two Months Due to Branding."



Do you think these are good practices ?

Do you have a role to play against such practices? Read the following text to know what you can do to stop such bad things from the society.

● SGP-1

- **Read the following text silently and answer the questions that follow :**

Every month two or three babies die due to branding in our state. When a baby has a fever or diarrhea or any other diseases, the illiterate parents and grandparents call the village quack, the disari. The quack, the village doctor puts hot iron rods on the stomach of the babies as a cure. Instead of getting cured, the babies die. But these blind practices continue.

What can we do to check such blind practices ? You are studying in schools. You know if we suffer from diseases, we should go to a qualified doctor, not to an illiterate disari or a village quack. As you are educated, you have a role to play in this regard. Tell the people not to go to a disari or a village quack. Ask them to go to a hospital for treatment. Talk to your classmates, form a group to fight against the bad and blind practices of branding in and around your village and locality.

- **Comprehension Questions :**

1. What is the topic about ?
2. What happens to two to three babies in our state every month ?
3. When do illiterate people or grandparents call a village quack ?
4. Do you think it is a good practice ?
5. What does the village quack do ?
6. Why does he put the hot iron rods on the stomach of the babies ?
7. Do the babies get well ? What happens to them ?
8. Where should we go to if we suffer from a disease ?
9. Who shouldn't we go to ?
10. What have you got to do? Why ?
11. What should you tell the people ?
12. What do you think is a better place to go- a village quack or a doctor ?
13. What should you do ?

Word Note : (The words/phrases have been defined mostly on their contextual meanings)

battle	- fight, ସଂଘର୍ଷ, ଯୁଦ୍ଧ
beat	- no one can do better in arrow shooting, defeat , ହରାଇ ପାରିବା
beaten	- punished with heavy thrashing, ମାଡ଼ ଖାଇଥିଲେ
branding	- giving marks with hot iron , ତତଲା ଲୁହା ଦାଗ ଦେବା
captured	- caught(him), ଧରି ନେଇଥିଲେ
cowboy	- someone who looks after cows, ଗାଈ ଜଗୁଆଳୀ
defeated	- were beaten, ପରାସ୍ତ ହୋଇଥିଲେ
documentary	- a film giving facts, ତଥ୍ୟଭିତ୍ତିକ, ପ୍ରାମାଣିକ ଚଳଚ୍ଚିତ୍ର
evil	- bad spirit, ଖରାପ ଆତ୍ମା, ପ୍ରେତାତ୍ମା
gathered	- came in large number to one place, ଏକାଠି ହୋଇଥିଲେ
innocent	- good and harmless people, ନିରାହ, ନିର୍ଦୋଷ ବ୍ୟକ୍ତି
mercilessly	- cruelly, ଭୀଷଣ ନିର୍ଦ୍ଦୟ ଭାବରେ
money lender	- a person who gives money to people in their need and collects it afterwards with interest, ଟଙ୍କା ସୁଧ କାରବାର କରୁଥିବା ବ୍ୟକ୍ତି
movement	- mass fight to achieve something, ଆନ୍ଦୋଳନ
pattas	- land ownership papers, ଜମି ପତ୍ର
poisoned	- (He was)given poison, ବିଷ ଦିଆଯାଇଥିଲା
poverty	- a condition of having no money, no wealth or basic needs of life, ଦାରିଦ୍ର୍ୟ, ଗରିବ ଅବସ୍ଥା
property	- wealth, ଧନସମ୍ପତ୍ତି
quack	- a person who does treatment of people without proper knowledge, especially in villages , ଗାଁ ବଇଦ, ଗୁଣିଆ
religious	- one who shows strong faith in religion and obey its rules, ଧର୍ମନିଷ୍ଠ, ଧାର୍ମିକ
reward	- wealth or money given to somebody for good work, ପୁରସ୍କାର
sacrificed	- gave life for the cause of his country, ଦେଶପାଇଁ ଜୀବନ ଉତ୍ସର୍ଗ କରିଥିଲେ
sacrifice	- to give a gift of animal (goat) to god or godless to win their favour, ବଳିଦାନ କରିବା
Santal	- a class of tribal, ଏକ ଆଦିବାସୀ ସମ୍ପ୍ରଦାୟ
superstition	- belief without based on facts, blind belief, ଅସବିଶ୍ୱାସ
suspected	- believed, ସନ୍ଦେହ ପ୍ରକଟ କରିବା, ବିଶ୍ୱାସ କରିବା
tearful	- sorrowful way, ଅଶ୍ରୁଳ, ଦୁଃଖଦ
weapons	- instruments used for fight like sword, gun etc., ଅସ୍ତ୍ରଶସ୍ତ୍ର
worship	- pray, ପୂଜା କରିବା ବା ପ୍ରାର୍ଥନା
wounded	- injured, cut (his leg), ହାଣି ହୋଇଯିବା, କ୍ଷତାକ୍ତ ହେବା, ଆହତ

LESSON-5

THE KIND TREE

Session - 1

I Pre-reading

- i. Do you like trees? What do trees give people?
- ii. Do you think they are kind? Why?

II While-reading

TEXT

- Read the poem silently and answer the questions that follow :

Trees are the kindest things I know,
They don't harm, and they simply grow.
And spread a shade for sleepy cows,
And gather birds among the boughs.

They are the first when day's begun,
To touch the beams of morning sun.
They are the last to hold the light,
When evening changes into night.

And when a moon floats on the sky,
They hum a drowsy lullaby
of sleepy children long ago,
Trees are the kindest things I know.



- Your teacher reads the poem aloud .You listen to him/her without opening the book.
- Your teacher asks you: What are described in the poem?
- Your teacher reads the poem aloud second time. You listen to him/her and at the same time see the poem.
- You read the poem silently and answer the following questions.

☛ Comprehension Questions :

1. What is the poem about ?
2. What are the trees like - cruelest or kindest ?
3. Who knows that trees are kind ?
4. Why does the poet say that trees are kind ?
5. What do trees do for the cows ?

